



Computer Networks

计算机网络 (CST2398)

2025-2026 学年第二学期 (26-Spring)

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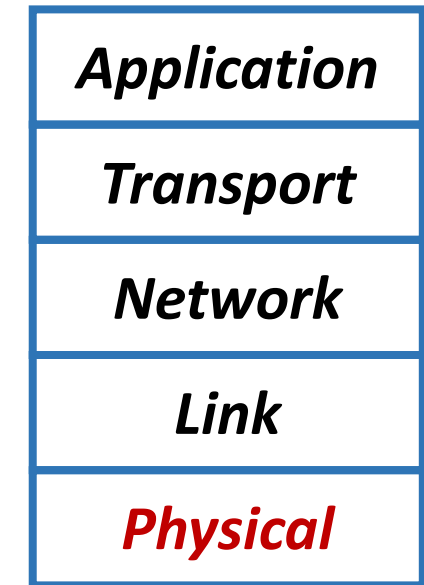
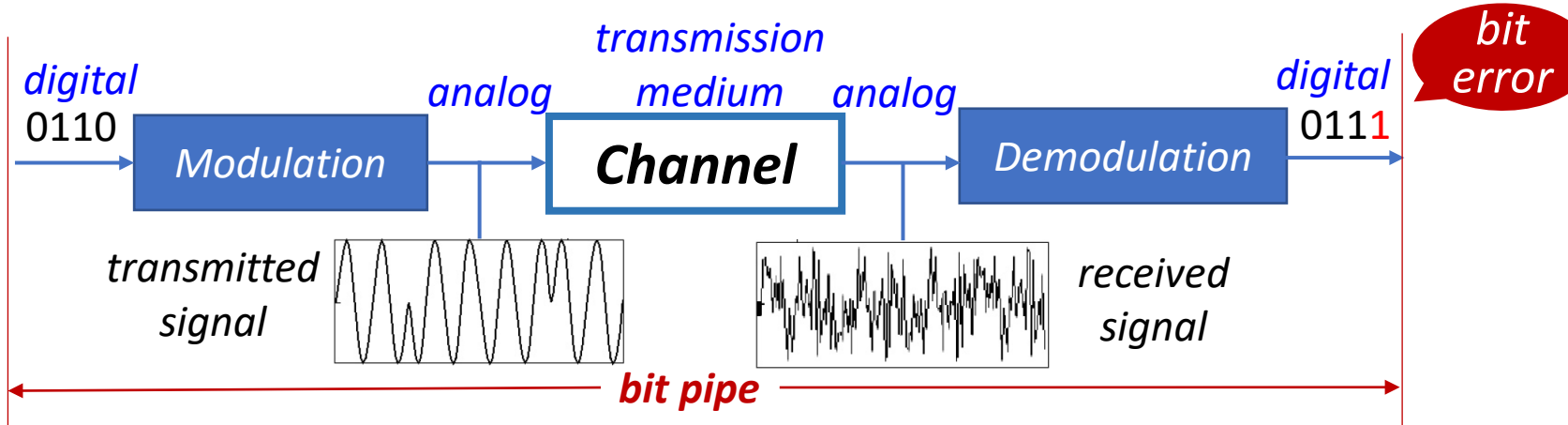


02

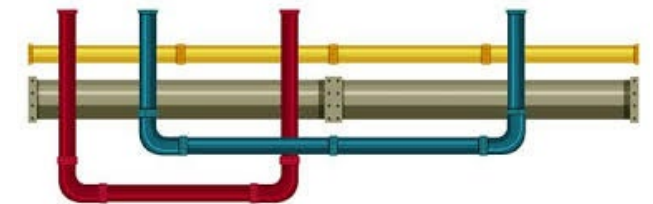
PHY Layer

Contents of this Chapter

- **Bandwidth (带宽)** and **Data Rate**
- **Modulation (调制)** of a Signal (ASK, PSK, QPSK, QAM)
- **Medium and Transmission (传输)**
- **Multiplexing (复用)** (FDMA, TDMA, CDMA)



Providing a **bit pipe**





2.1

BW and Data Rate

Frequency and Bandwidth-limited Signal

Representing
a periodic signal

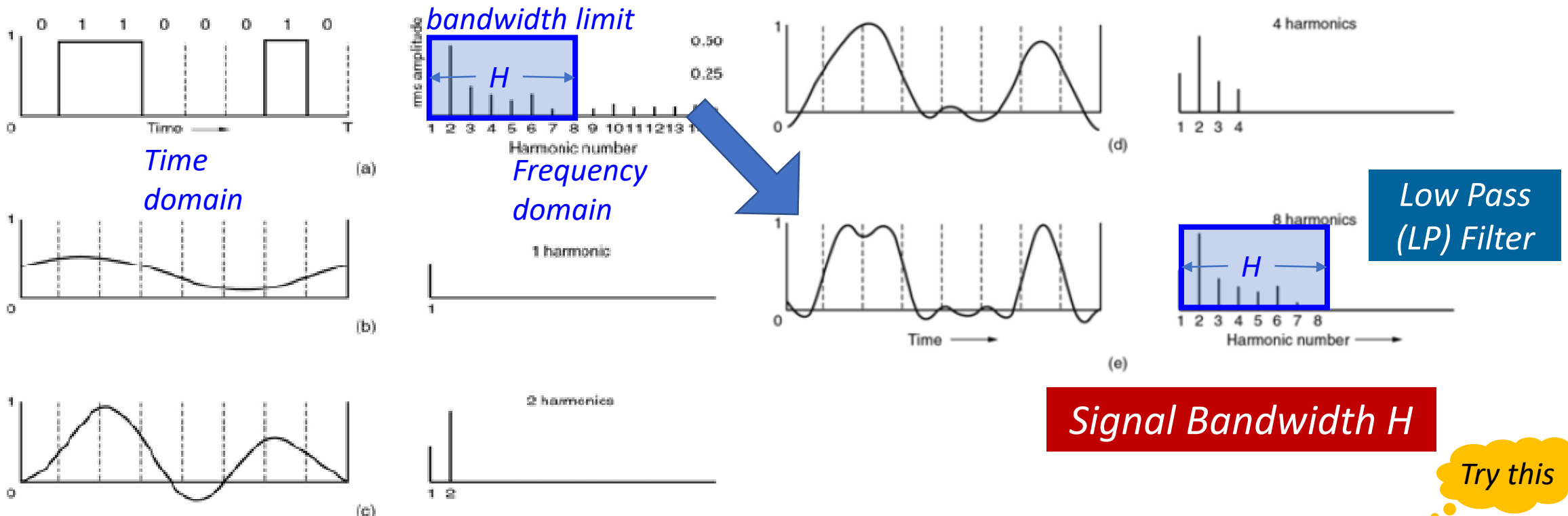
$$g(t) = \frac{c}{2} + \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} a_n \sin(2\pi nft) + \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} b_n \cos(2\pi nft)$$

Harmonics 谐波

Non-periodic signal

Fourier Transform 傅立叶变换

Frequency domain

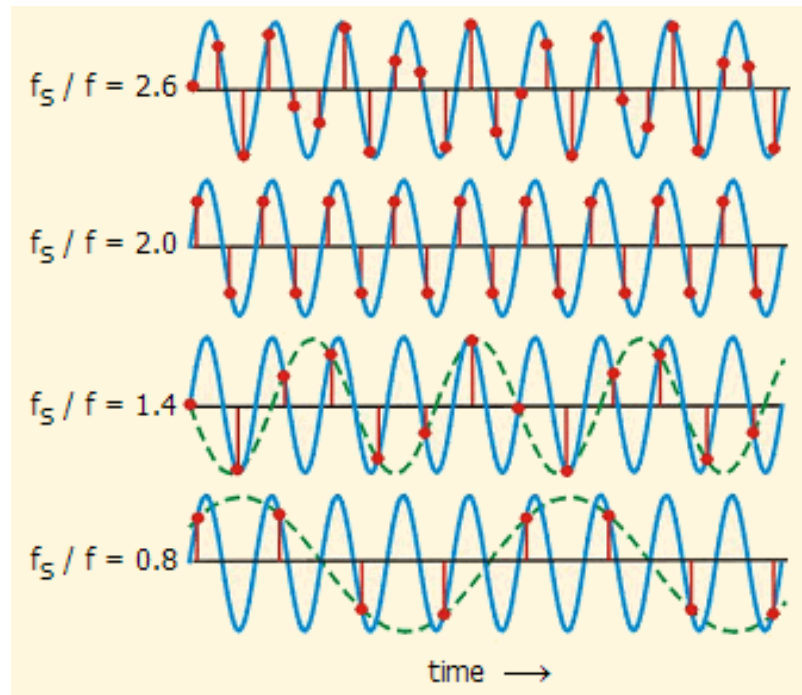


Nyquist Sampling: restoring the signal

- For a signal with bandwidth H ,

Nyquist Sampling Rule

- To reconstruct the signal (fully), we need $2H$ samples per second.
- Or (if sampling frequency $< 2H$), there will be **aliasing(混叠)**.



OK

OK

Aliasing

Aliasing

Try this

http://webapps.chem.uoa.gr/efs/applets/AppletNyquist/App1_Nyquist2.html

Channel Bandwidth and Data Rate

- For a channel with bandwidth BW,

Due to
Quantization

- **Noiseless** channel: V is the # of levels of the signal

$$\text{max datarate } R_{\max} = 2 BW \log_2 V \text{ bps}$$

Nyquist Theorem



- **Noisy** channel: S is the signal strength, N is the noise strength/power

$$\text{max datarate } C = BW \log_2 \left(1 + \frac{S}{N}\right) \text{ bps}$$

Shannon Theorem

A Mathematical Theory
of Communication, 1948

信道容量

Shannon Capacity

The maximum # of bits a channel of BW
wide allows in one second.

$$\text{SNR (signal to noise ratio, 信噪比)} = \frac{S}{N}$$

$$\text{SNR (dB)} = 10 \log_{10} \frac{S}{N}$$

decibels

SNR = 3 dB,
 $S/N = ?$



2.2

Modulation

Modulation: Digital -> Analog

- **Modulation Process**: switching (also called keying) the **amplitude**(幅度), **frequency**(频率), or **phase**(相位) of the carrier (载波) in accordance with the information (binary digits, 0s and 1s)

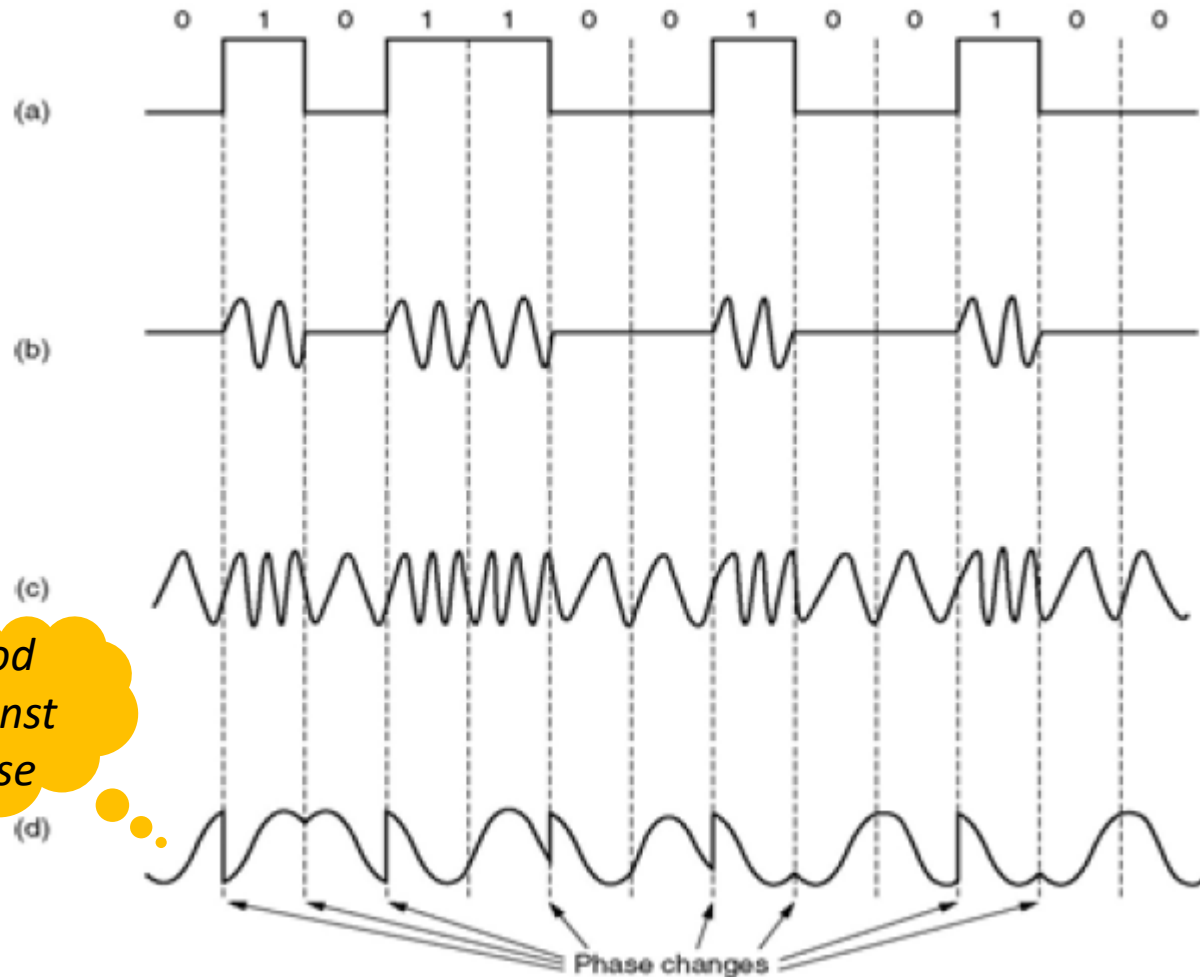
Digital: binary digits that carries information



Analog Signal: $s(t) = A \cos(2\pi f t + \theta)$

- **Why**: channel/medium permits bandpass (BW-limited) signal

Types of Modulation



$$s(t) = A \cos(2\pi f t + \theta)$$

Or a combination

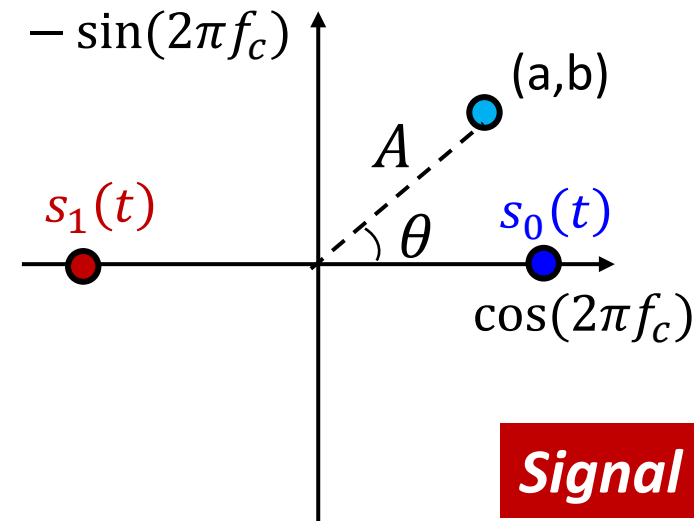
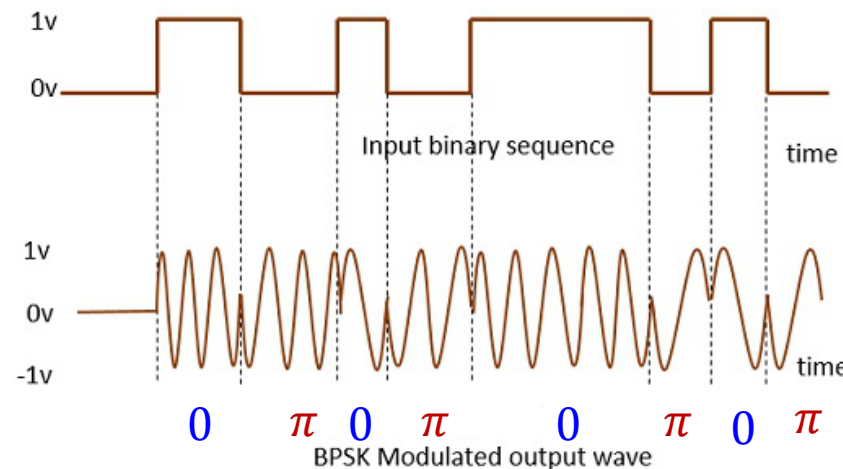
- a. A binary signal
- b. Amplitude Modulation (AM) or **Amplitude Shifted Keying (ASK)**
- c. Frequency Modulation (FM) or **Frequency Shifted Keying (FSK)**
- d. Phase Modulation (PM) or **Phase Shifted Keying (PSK)**

Binary Phase Shift Keying (BPSK)

- **BPSK**: A binary digit (0 or 1) is mapped to a (usually high frequency f_c) carrier sinusoidal wave of a given **phase**.

- Binary digit **0**: $s_0(t) = A \cos(2\pi f_c t) = A \cos(2\pi f_c t + 0)$

- Binary digit **1**: $s_1(t) = -A \cos(2\pi f_c t) = A \cos(2\pi f_c t + \pi)$ $\pi: 180^\circ$



What are the coordinates of $s_0(t)$ and $s_1(t)$?

Signal Constellation

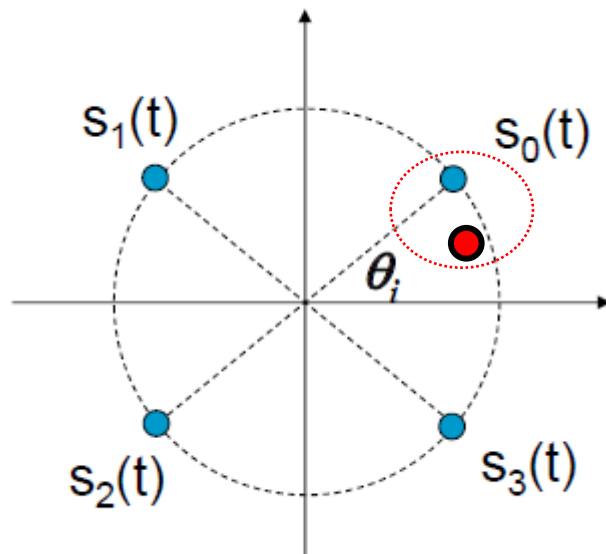
More PSK schemes

- **More than binary (2)!**

Why?
Data rate

- 4 -> **Q(uadratic) PSK**

- signal $s_i(t)$ -> a **symbol**



2 bits

$s_0(t)$ -- 00

$s_1(t)$ -- 01

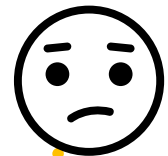
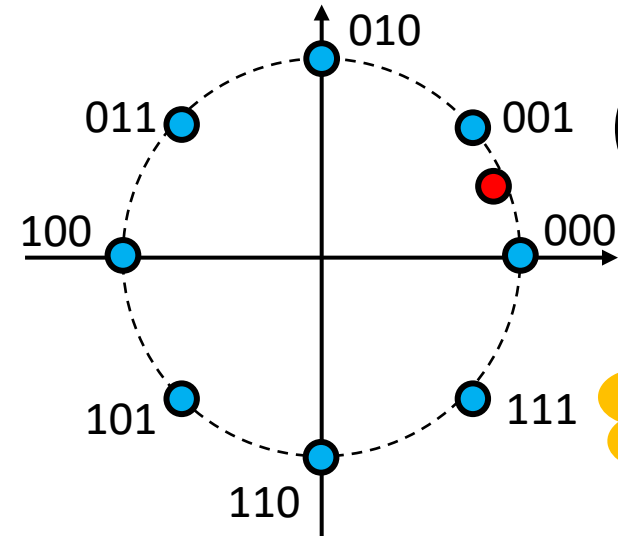
$s_2(t)$ -- 10

$s_3(t)$ -- 11



- **8PSK**

- signal $s_i(t)$ -> a symbol of 3 bits

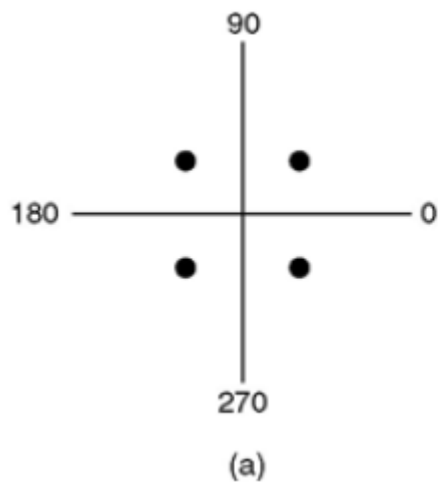


But ...
Demod is
more difficult

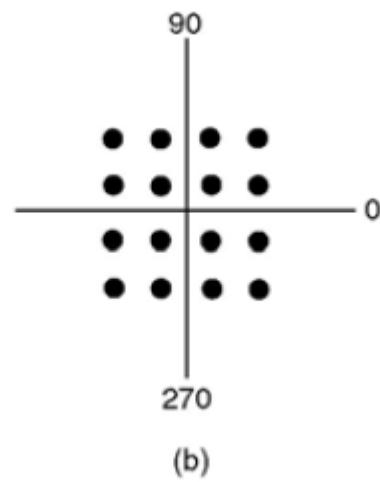
Real-world Modem: QAM

- **QAM**: Quadratic Amplitude Modulation

- Changing: Phase and Amplitude

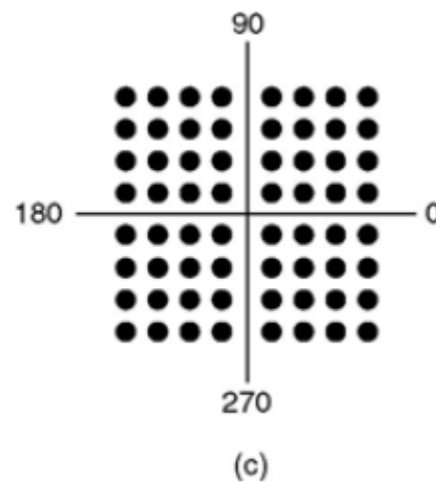


QPSK



QAM-16

4 bits/symbol



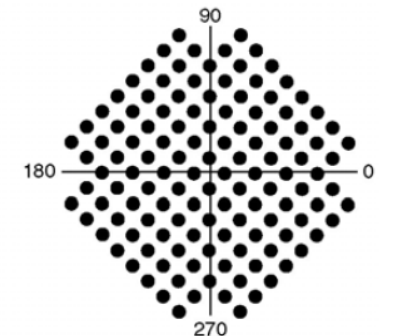
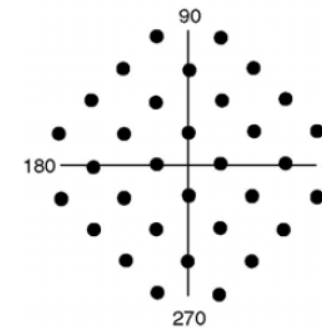
QAM-64

6 bits/symbol

- Modem sampling rate:
2400 Baud 1 Baud = 1 sample/s

Data rate:

- QAM-32*: 9.6 kbps
- QAM-128*: 14.4 kbps



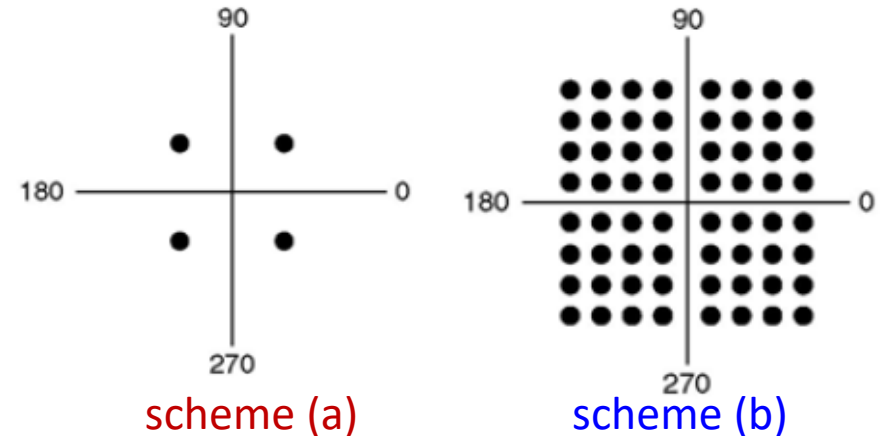
*: not the max data rate

Ex.2.1 Data Rate, Bandwidth, Channel Capacity

Consider two modulation schemes represented by the following diagrams:

- Baud Rate (波特率) : 8 Baud/s (i.e. 8000 symbols/s)
- Each symbol is represented by one of these points

How many bits?



• **Questions: For each scheme,**

- 1) What kind of modulation is being used here?
- 2) What is the data rate (in bps) for this modulated signal?
- 3) For a noisy channel with Bandwidth 10 KHz, what is the minimum SNR to achieve this data rate?

Ex.2.1 Data Rate, Bandwidth, Channel Capacity

Consider two modulation schemes represented by the following diagrams:

- Baud Rate (波特率) : 8 Baud/s (i.e. 8000 symbols/s)
- Each symbol is represented by one of these points

Scheme (a)

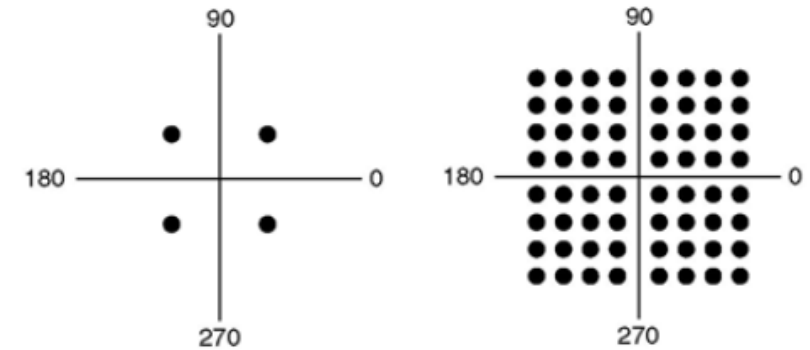
- 1) QPSK
- 2) Signal data rate: 8K sample/s * 2 bit/sample = 16 kbps,
- 3) Channel BW = 10 KHz, channel capacity (max possible data rate)

$$C = BW \log_2 \left(1 + \frac{S}{N} \right) \geq 16 \text{ kbps}$$

$$\text{So } SNR \geq 2^{1.6} - 1 \simeq 2.03$$

Scheme (b)

- 1) QAM-64
- 2) Data rate: 8K sample/s * 6 bit/sample = 48 kbps
- 3) $SNR \geq 2^{4.8} - 1 \simeq 26.86$



scheme (a)

scheme (b)

Good channel condition
-> higher modulation ->
higher data rate

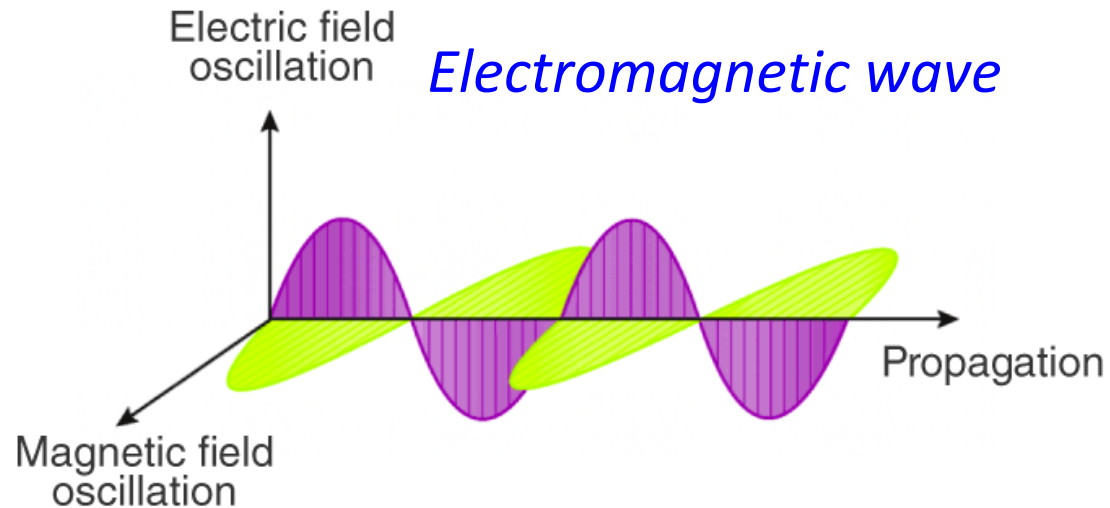


2.3

Transmission

Transmission/Physical Media

- **Media:** where analog *signal* (that carries information) propagates

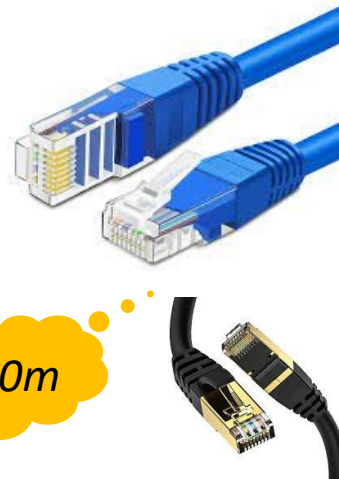
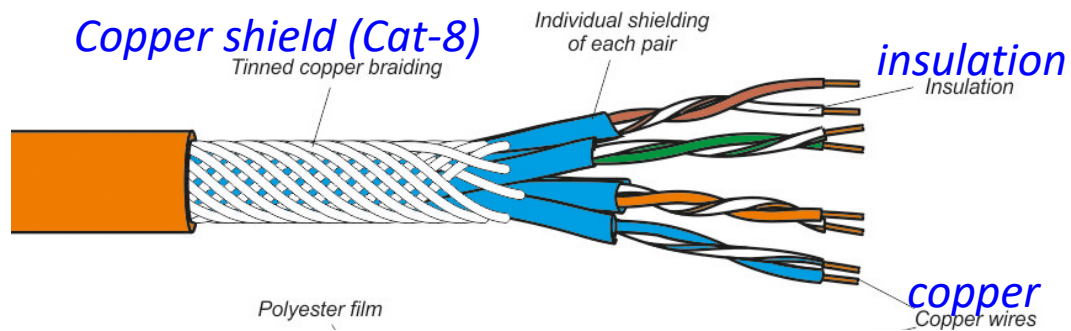


- **Guided media:** signal propagates along a direction, usually solid media, e.g. copper (wire), fiber, co-ax cable
- **Unguided media:** signal propagates freely, e.g. air, vacuum

- **Physical link:** the media between the sender and receiver

Guided Media (1/2)

- **Twisted Pair (双绞线)**

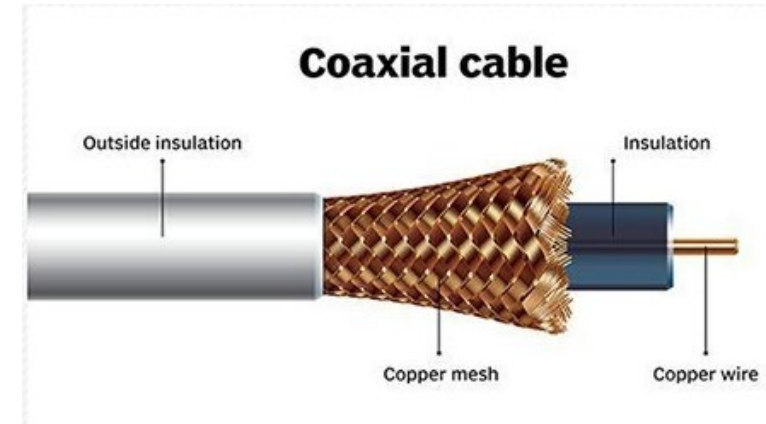


< 100m

- **Cat-3:** phone wire
- **Cat-5:** 100 Mbps Ethernet
- **Cat-5e:** 1 Gbps Ethernet
- **Cat-6:** 10 Gbps Ethernet
- **Cat-8:** 40 Gbps data-center

- **Coaxial Cable (同轴电缆)**

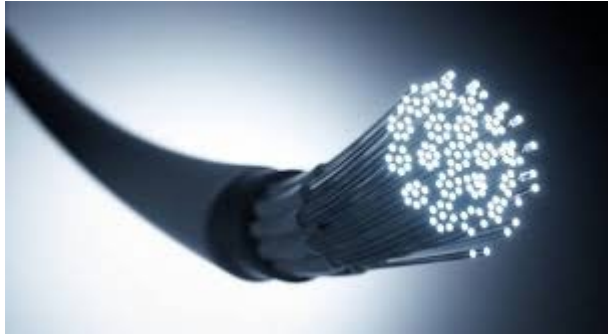
Co-ax



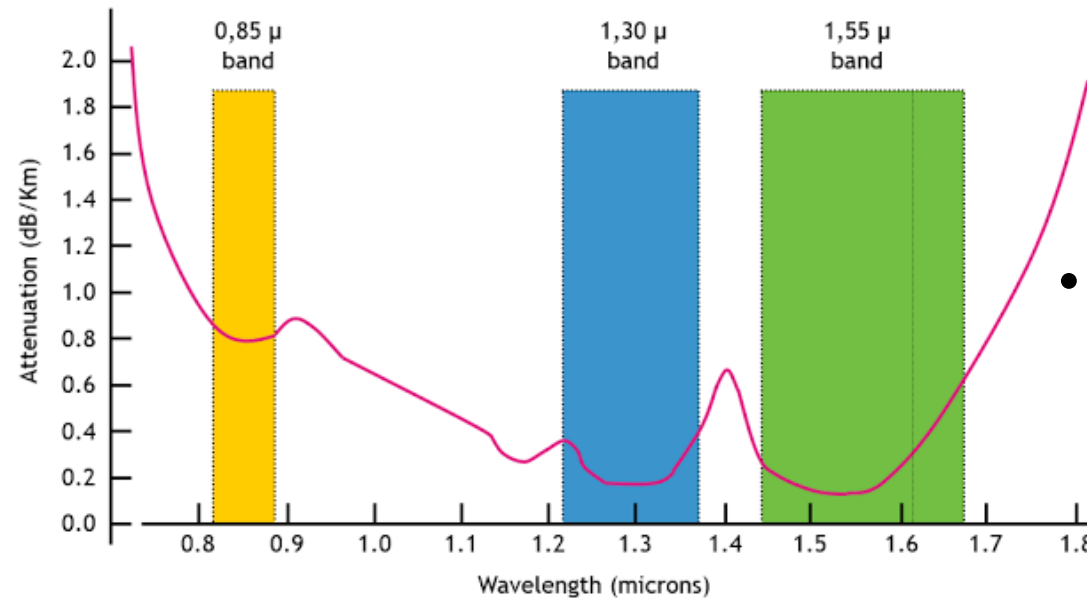
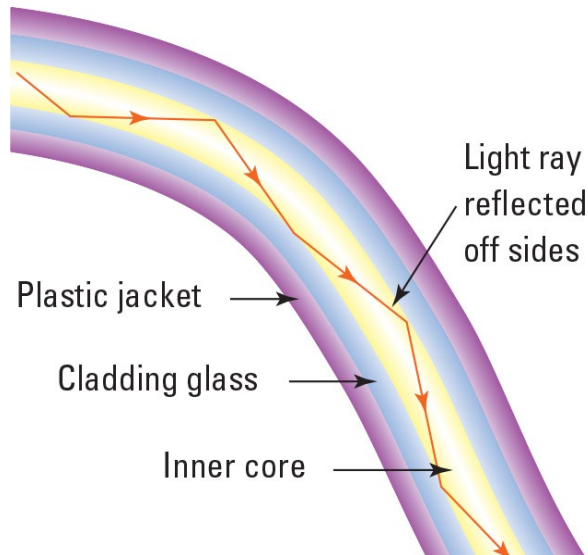
- Cable broadband Internet
- Aircraft, military, medical
- TV, video equipment

Guided Media (2/2)

- **Fiber Optic cable (光纤):** glass fiber carrying light pulses



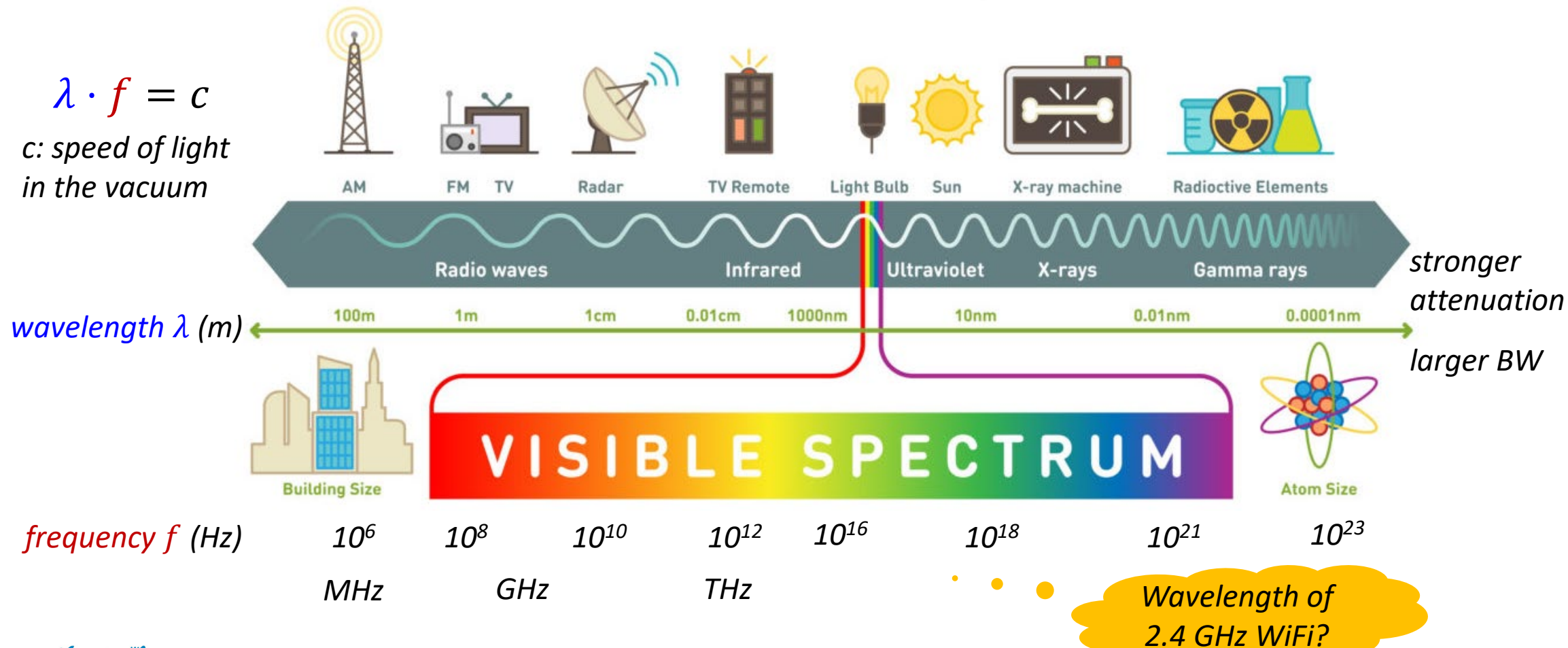
- **High speed:** 10-100 Gbps
- **Low error rate:** $< 10^{-12}$ immune to electromagnetic noise
- **Long distance:** > 100 Km

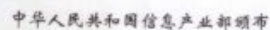


- **Multi-mode:**
 - Low cost
 - LED
 - short distance (Kms)
- **Single-mode:**
 - Expensive
 - Laser
 - long distance (100 Km)

The Electromagnetic Spectrum

- A valuable (and expensive) resource



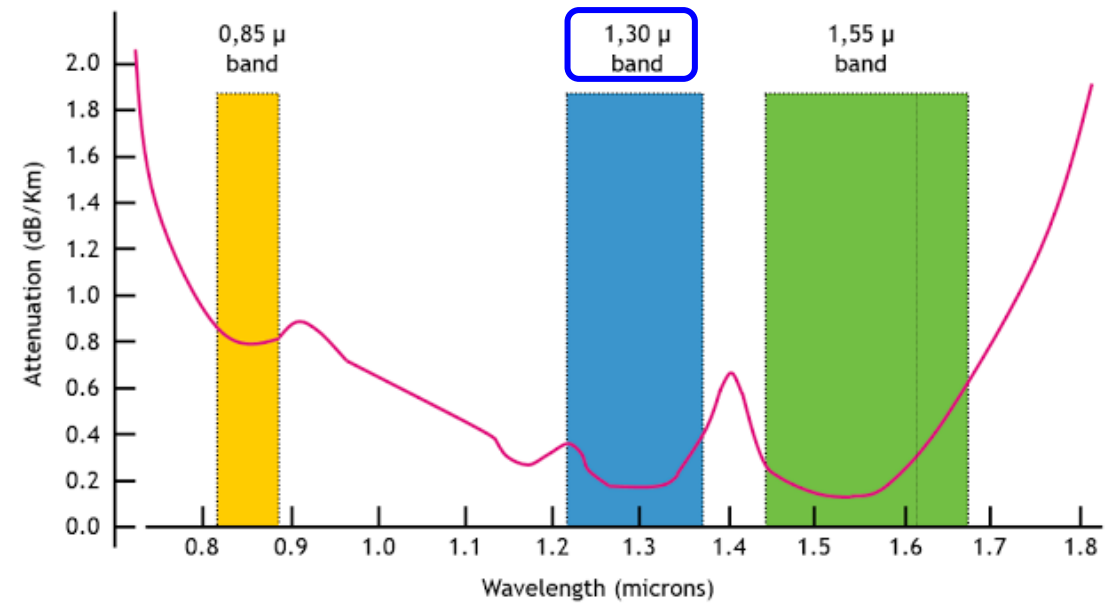
PART OF FREQUENCY ALLOCATIONS
PEOPLE'S REPUBLIC OF CHINA

Ex.2.2 Frequency, Wavelength, and BW

Consider the **1.3-micron band**:

- Central frequency wavelength
 $\lambda = 1.3 \mu m = 1.3 \times 10^{-6} m$
- Range of the wavelength $\Delta\lambda = 0.17\mu m$:
 $\lambda_{min} = \lambda - 0.085 \mu m$
 $\lambda_{max} = \lambda + 0.085 \mu m$
- Speed of light $c = 3 \times 10^8 m/s$

Find: the bandwidth BW for this band.



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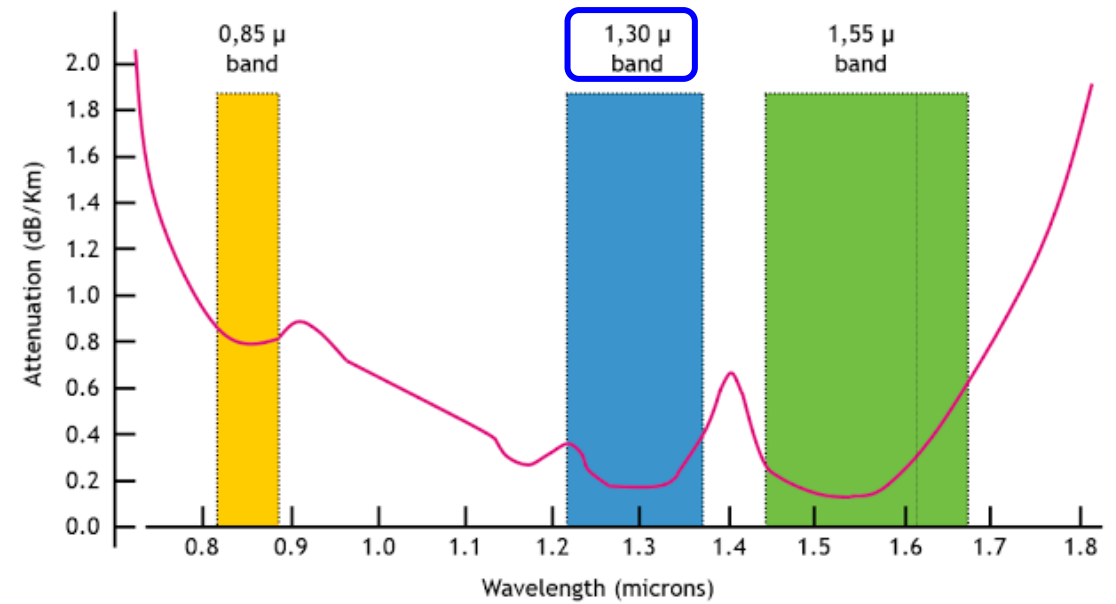
- Lowest frequency

$$f_{\min} = \frac{c}{\lambda_{\max}} = 2.17 \times 10^{14} \text{ Hz}$$

- highest frequency

$$f_{\max} = \frac{c}{\lambda_{\min}} = 2.47 \times 10^{14} \text{ Hz}$$

- $BW = f_{\max} - f_{\min} = 3 \times 10^{13} \text{ Hz} = 30 \text{ THz}$



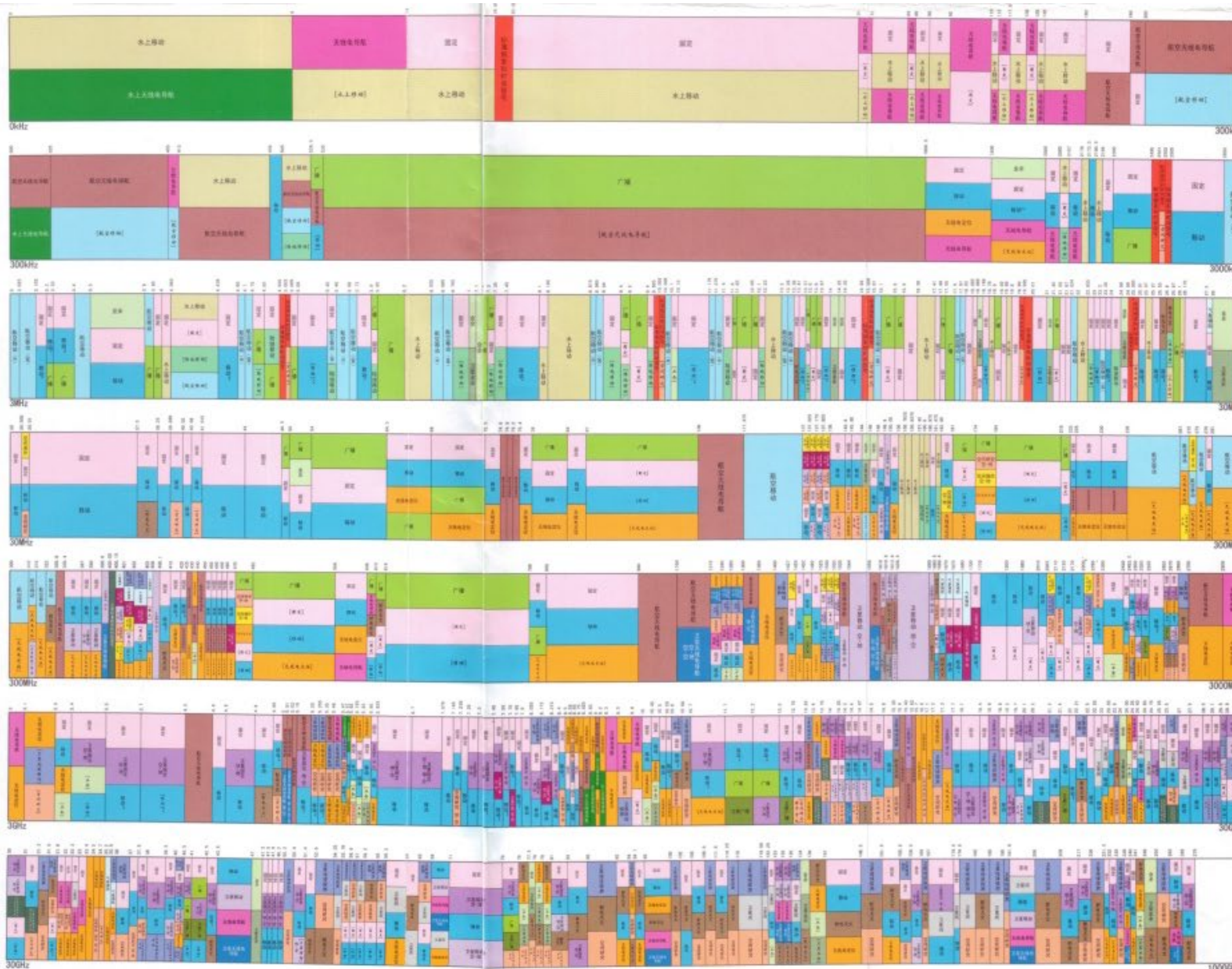
Fiber communication has a large BW, so it has a huge capacity.
-> used in backbone

中华人民共和国 无线电频率划分图

CHART OF FREQUENCY ALLOCATIONS
THE PEOPLE'S REPUBLIC OF CHINA



中华人民共和国信息产业部颁布

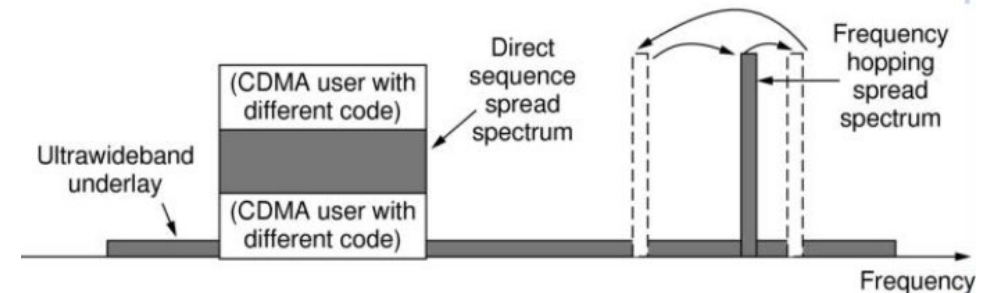


Very crowded

Transmission – Narrow Band v.s. Wide Band

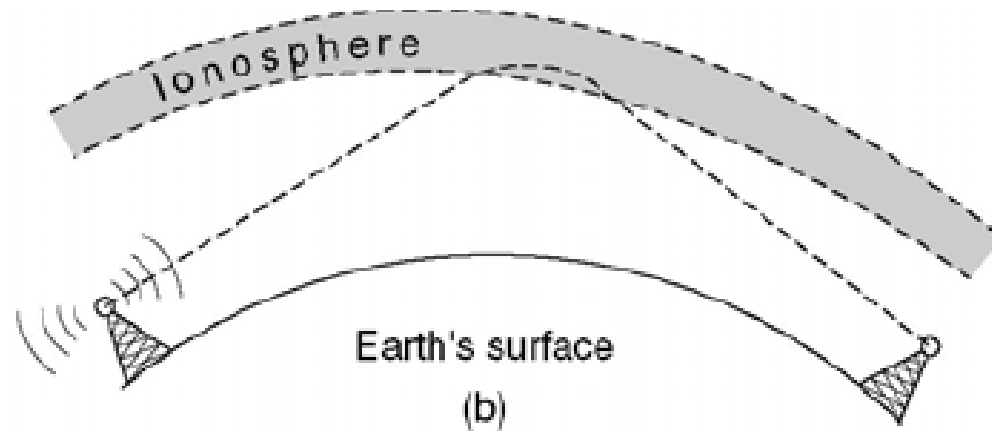
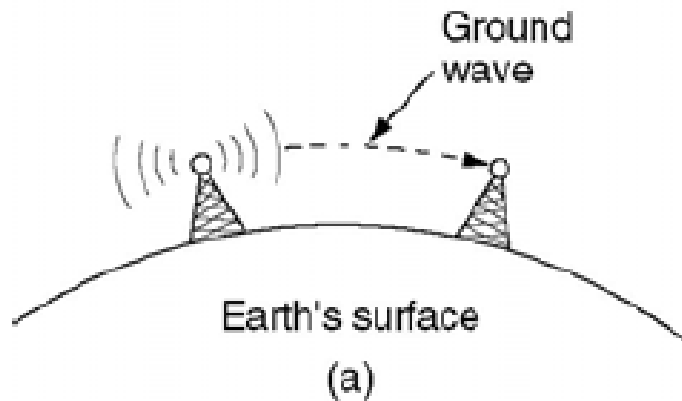
- **Most transmission use a narrow frequency band.**
 - **narrow**: small $\frac{BW}{f_c}$
 - Why: good reception
- **Wide band transmission (Spread Spectrum) is also widely used.**
 - Frequency Hopping Spread Spectrum (FHSS)
 - Transmitter hops (over 100 times/s) from frequency to frequency. Receiver hops too.
 - Hard to detect, almost impossible to jam. E.g. military use.
 - Direct Sequence Spread Spectrum (DSSS)
 - Popular in mobile telecommunication, e.g. **CDMA**.
 - Good spectral efficiency.

Will learn
it today

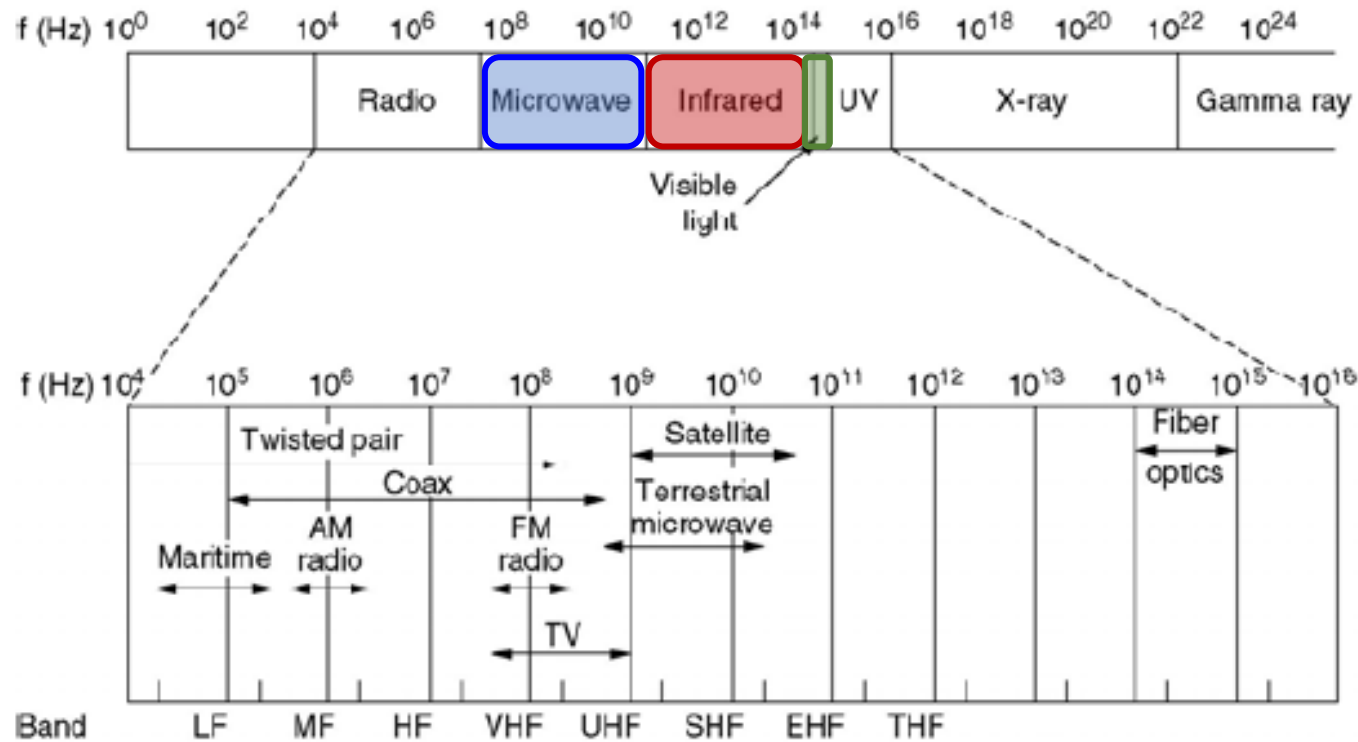


Radio Transmission

- In VLF (very low frequency), LF (low frequency) and MF (middle frequency) bands, radio waves follow the curvature of the earth.
- In HF (high frequency) band, radio waves are reflected by the ionosphere(电离层).



Wireless Transmission



- **Microwave (>100MHz)**

- Near straight lines
- Antenna high SNR
- Repeaters needed
- Multipath fading

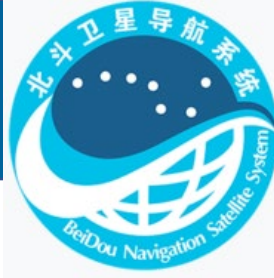
- **Infrared, mmWave**

- Short range
- More like light than radio, which is a good thing.

- **Lightwave**

- Line-of-sight

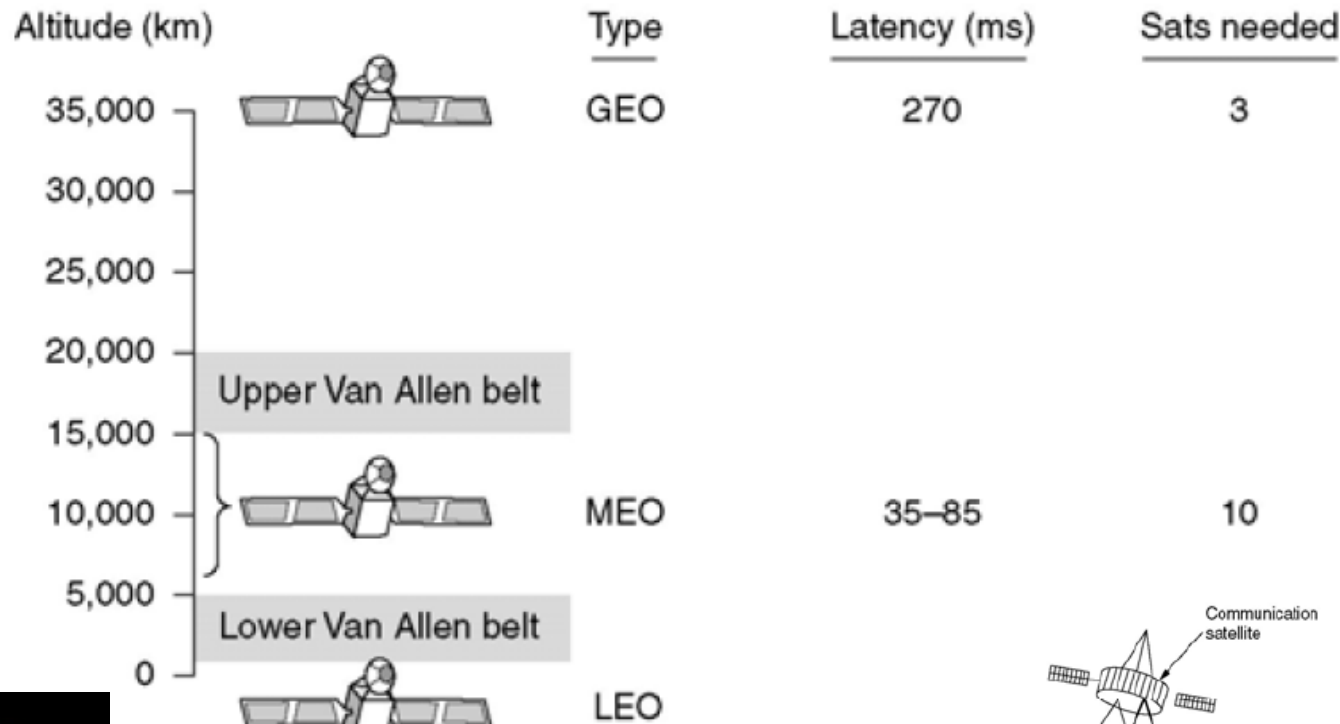
Communication Satellites



北斗3

3 GEO

24 MEO



• Geostationary

- Not interactive

• Medium-Earth Orbit

- E.g. GPS

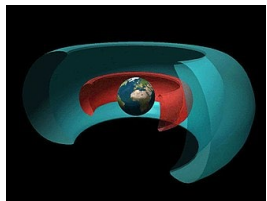
• Low-Earth Orbit

- E.g. Starlink

Summary of satellites, as of 19 May 2023

Block	Launch period	Satellite launches			Currently in orbit and healthy
		Success	Failure	Planned	
1	2000–2006	4	0	0	0
2	2007–2019	20	0	0	15
3	2015–present	36	0	0	31
Total		60	0	0	46

credit: Wiki



Van Allen Belts

credit: NASA

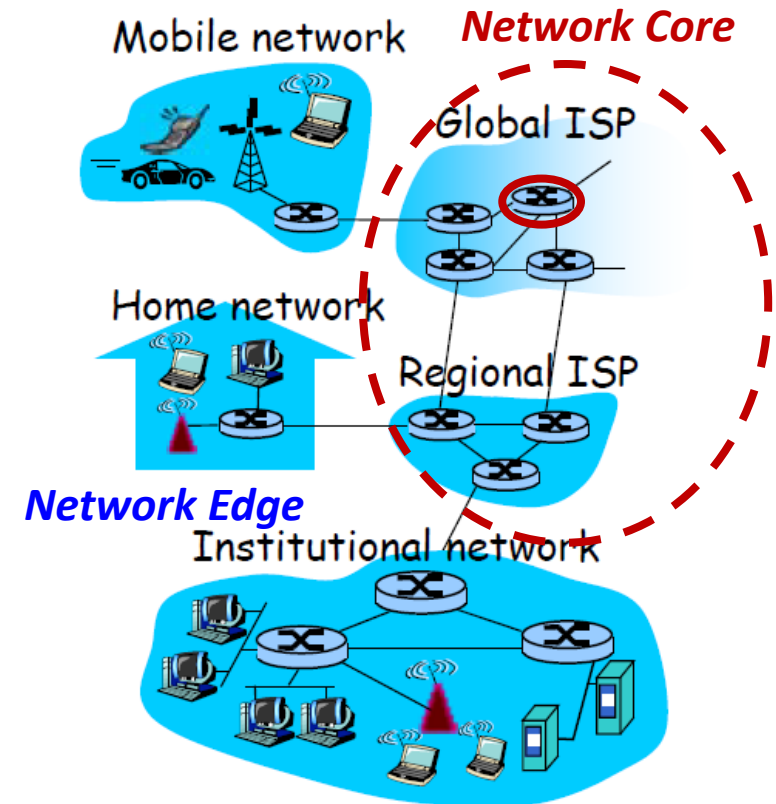
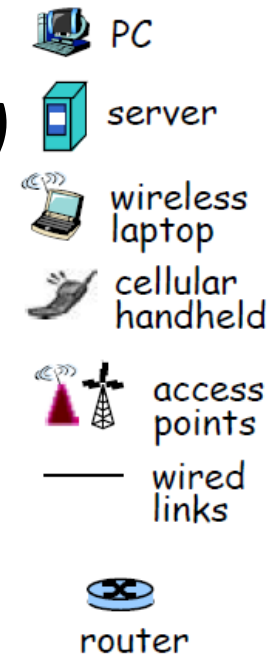
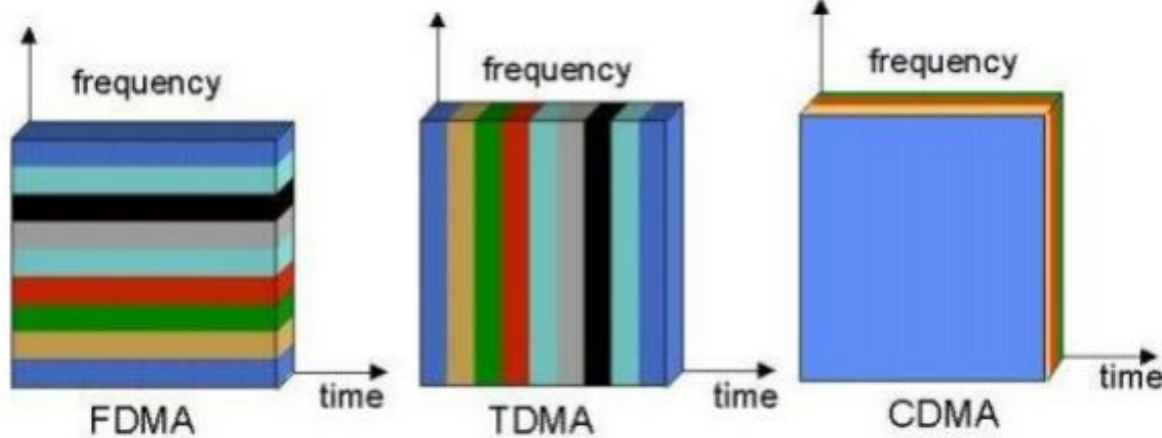


2.4

Multiplexing

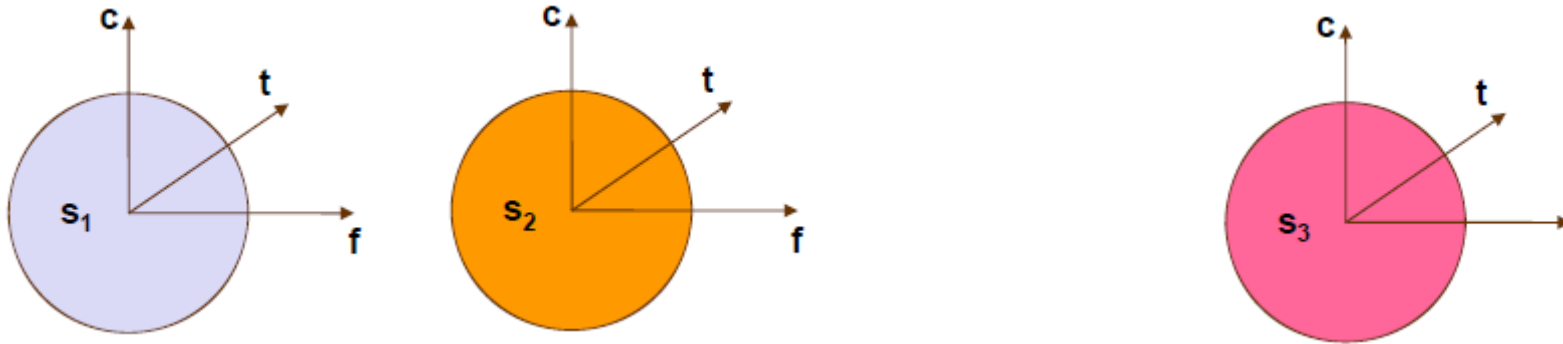
Multi-Access

- **Access Network: Accessing the edge router**
 - *Wired*
 - *Wireless*
- **Multi-user: multiple access (to channel)**



Multiplexing

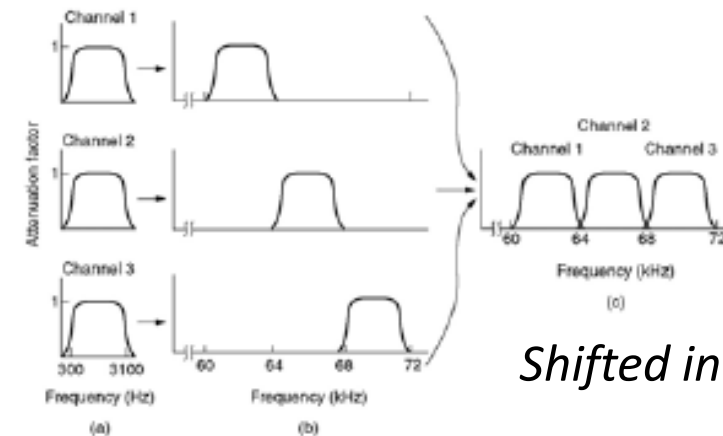
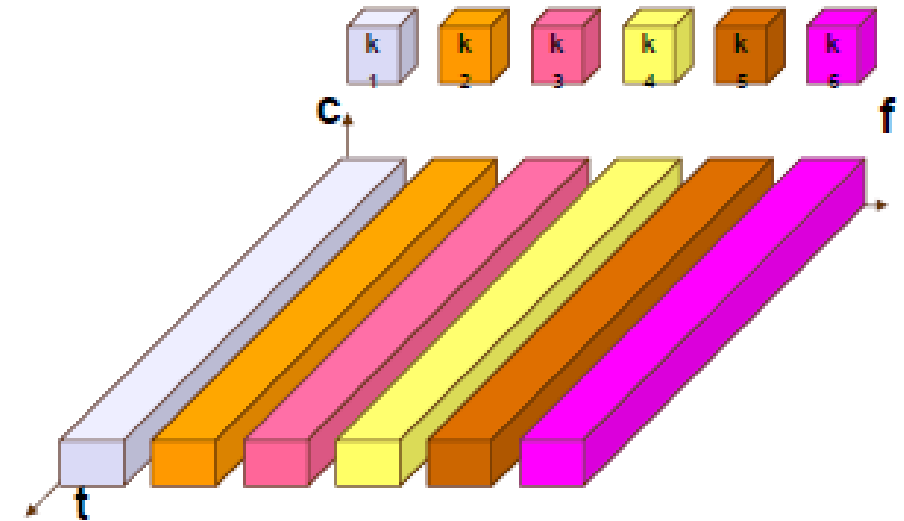
- **Multiplexing (复用):** merging *multiple* flows (of signals) on a *single medium*, so that multiple users can use a shared medium
- What to *divide/share*: *space (S)*, *time (T)*, *frequency (F)*, *code (C)*



**Space Division
Multiplexing
(SDM) 空分复用**

Frequency Division Multiplexing

- **FDM, FDMA** 频分复用
- *The spectrum is divided into smaller frequency bands.*
e.g. 2.4GHz: ISM bands
- *A channel contains a certain band of spectrum for the entire time.*

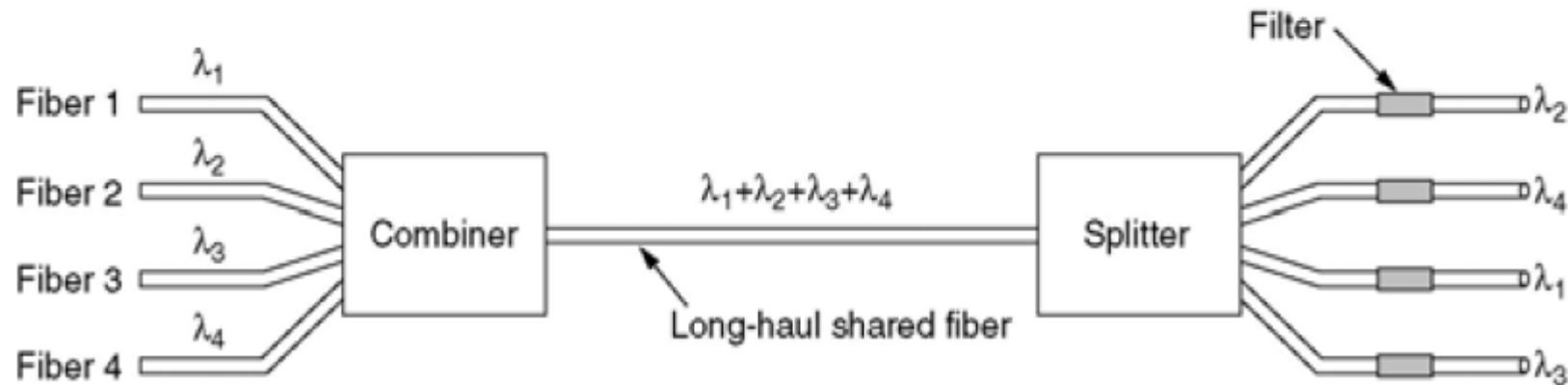
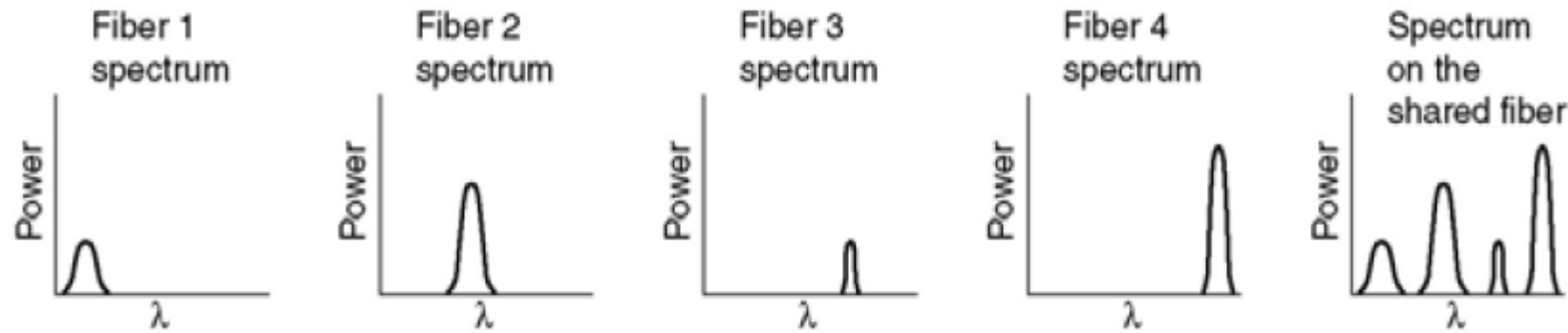


Shifted in frequency

Wavelength Division Multiplexing

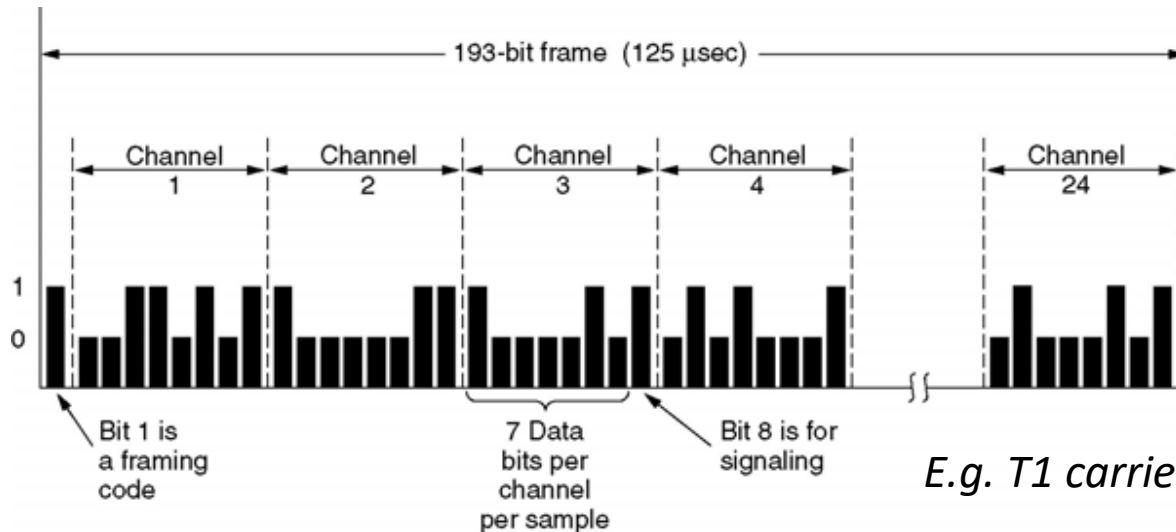
- **Fundamentally, the same as FDM, but on optics**

波分复用

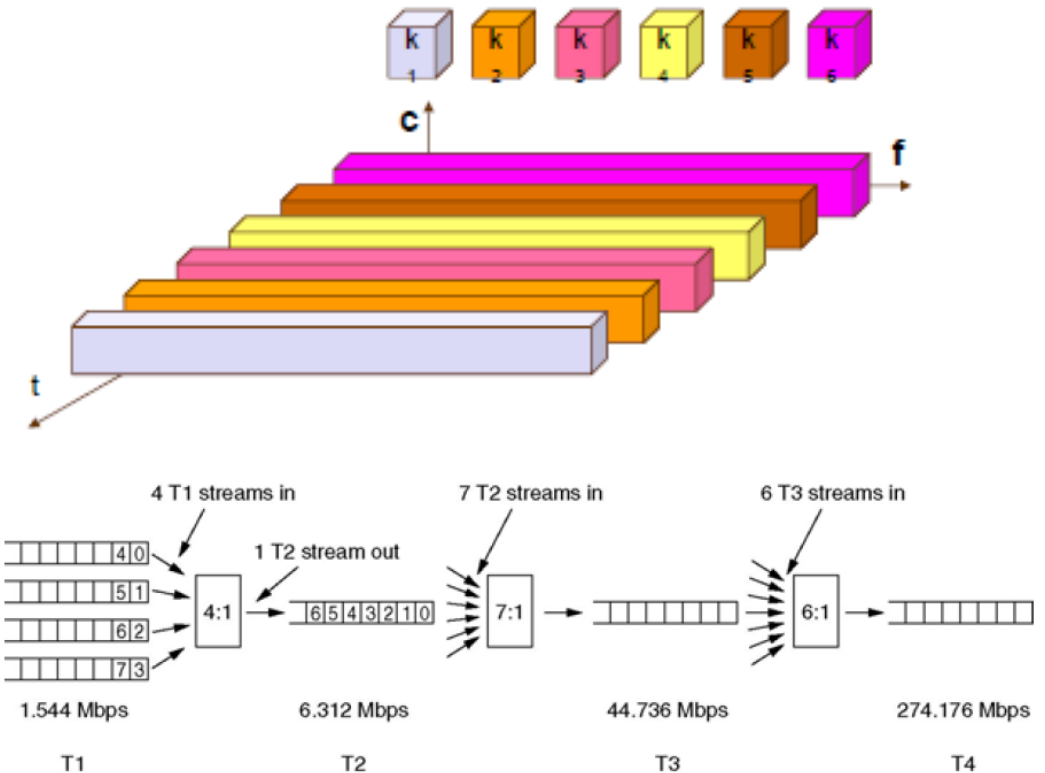


Time Division Multiplexing

- **TDM, TDMA** 时分复用
- A channel uses the entire spectrum for a certain amount of time.
- Disadvantage: synchronization (同步)

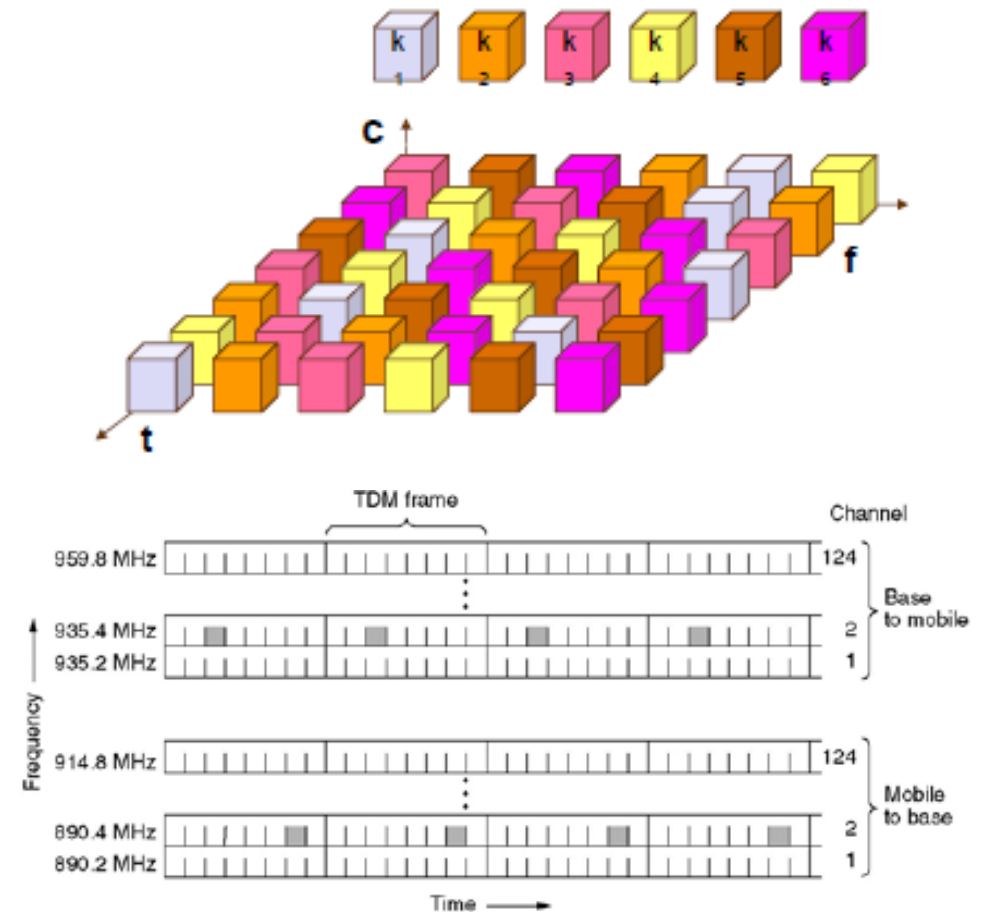


E.g. T1 carrier in telephony networks



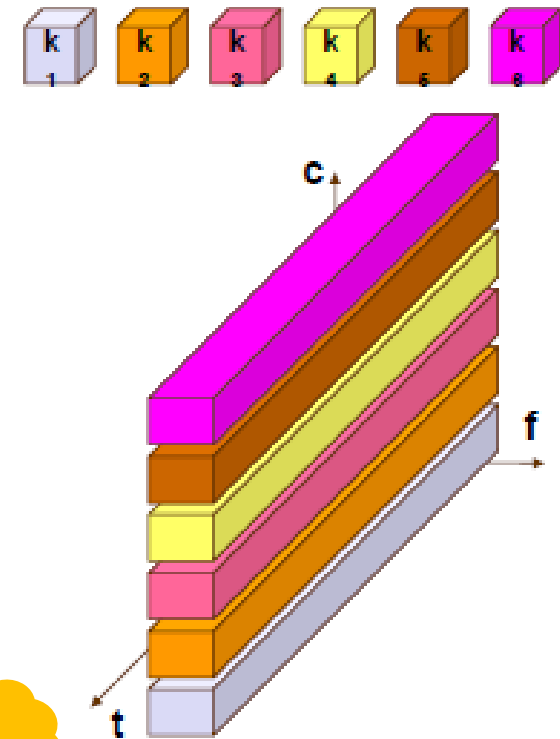
Time and Frequency Multiplexing

- **Combination of FDM and TDM**
- A channel uses a certain frequency band for a certain amount of time.
E.g. Global System for Mobile Communication (GSM, i.e. 2G)
- But: needs synchronization (同步), and coordination!



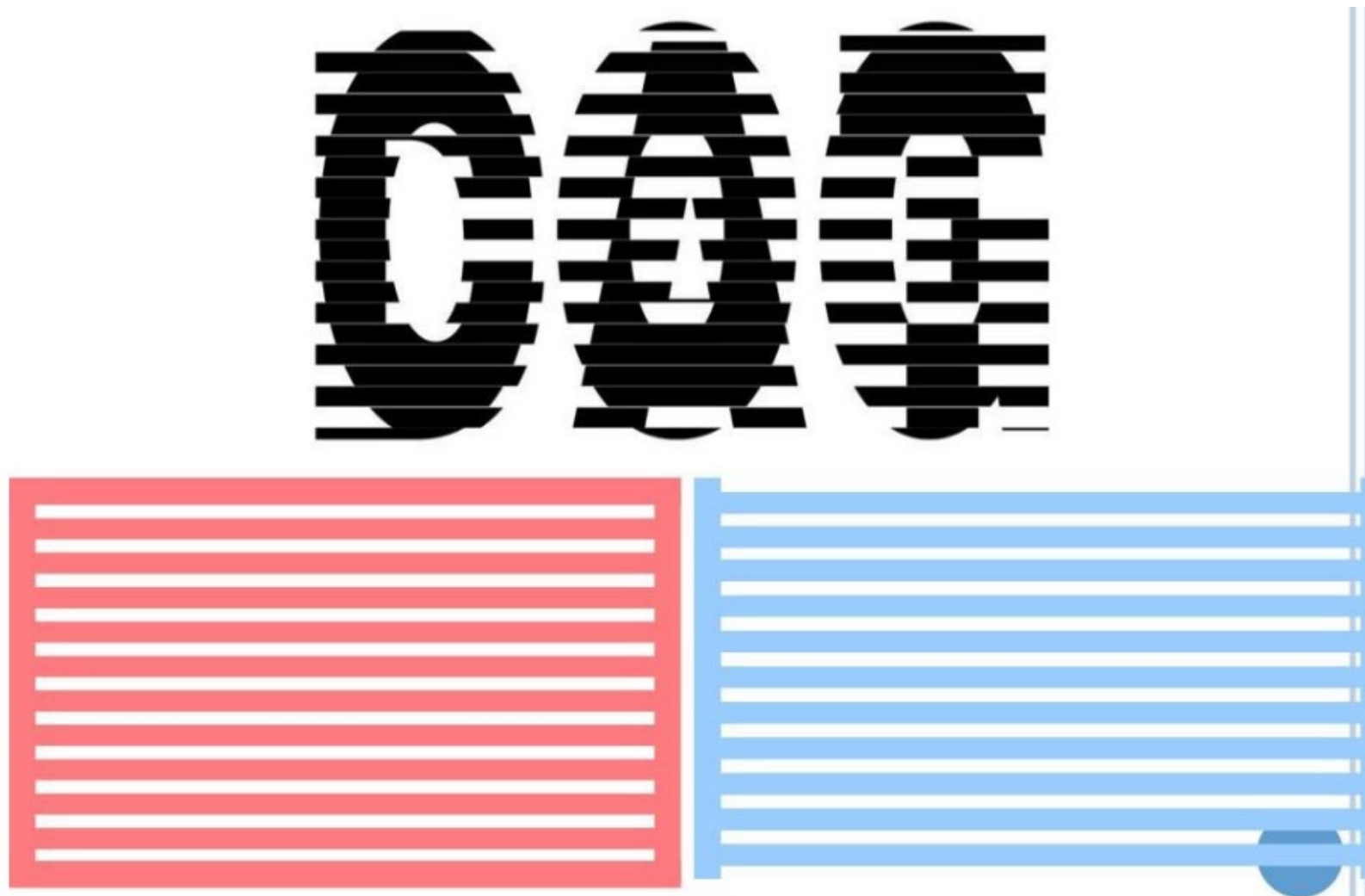
Code Division Multiplexing

- **CDM and CDMA** 码分复用
- Each channel uses the **same spectrum** at the **same time**.
E.g. CDMA2000, WCDMA (often used with space division multiplexing or FDM)
- Transmissions are separated using **coding theory**.



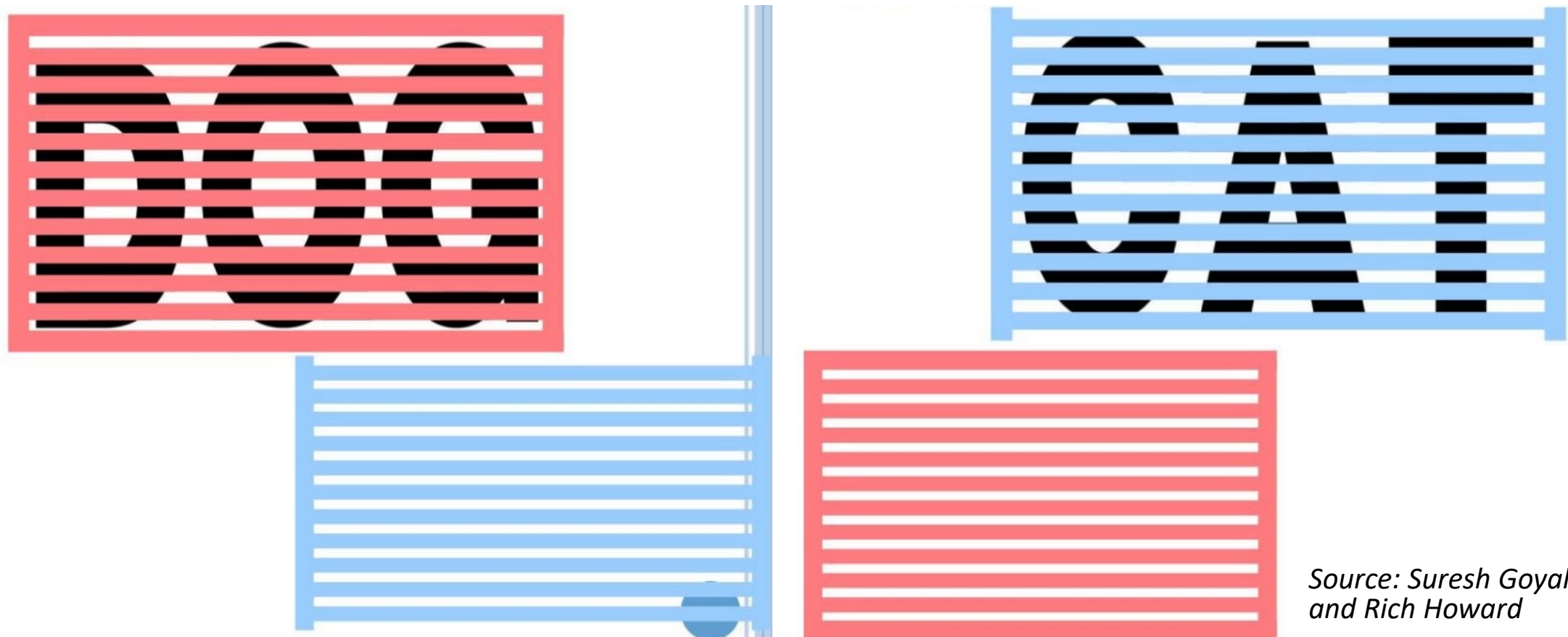
How?

Intuition of CDMA



*Source: Suresh Goyal and
Rich Howard*

Intuition of CDMA



*Source: Suresh Goyal
and Rich Howard*

More on CDMA

- Each bit time is divided into m short intervals called **chips**.
 - Usually, $m = 64$ or 128
- Each station A is assigned a unique **m -bits code** called a **chip sequence**, $A = \langle A_1, A_2, \dots, A_m \rangle$

1) Each A_i is **either 1 or -1**.. **Bipolar**

2) All chip sequences are **pairwise orthogonal (正交)**.

$$\langle A, B \rangle = \frac{1}{m} \sum_{i=1}^m A_i \cdot B_i = 0$$

3) Chip sequences are of **unit length**.

$$\langle A, A \rangle = \frac{1}{m} \sum_{i=1}^m A_i \cdot A_i = 1$$

m -chip
vector

How does CDMA work?

- **Three stations: A, B, C**

- **Chip sequences:**

- $A = \langle 1 \ 1 \ -1 \ -1 \rangle$

- $B = \langle 1 \ -1 \ 1 \ -1 \rangle$...

- $C = \langle 1 \ -1 \ -1 \ 1 \rangle$

Orthogonal

- **Transmits:**

- $T_A: 1$

- $T_B: 0$ (i.e. -1)

- $T_C: \text{does not transmit (i.e. 0)}$

- **In the air:**

$$S = 1 \cdot A + (-1) \cdot B + 0 \cdot C = ?$$

- **Receivers of A, B, and C:**

- $R_A: \langle S, A \rangle = 1$

- > transmitted 1

- $R_B: \langle S, B \rangle = -1$

- > transmitted 0

- $R_C: \langle S, C \rangle = 0$

- > did not transmit

Ex.2.3 CDMA

Four CDMA Stations and their chip sequences:

$$A = (-1 \ -1 \ -1 \ +1 \ +1 \ -1 \ +1 \ +1)$$

$$B = (-1 \ -1 \ +1 \ -1 \ +1 \ +1 \ +1 \ -1)$$

$$C = (-1 \ +1 \ -1 \ +1 \ +1 \ +1 \ -1 \ -1)$$

$$D = (-1 \ +1 \ -1 \ -1 \ -1 \ -1 \ +1 \ -1)$$

Consider the following cases, calculate the transmitted signal:

- 1) *C transmits 1, others do not transmit*
- 2) *A transmitted 1, B transmitted 0, others do not transmit*
- 3) *A, B, C, D all transmitted 1*

For receiver of C, what can be decoded from the received signal?

Summary of PHY (1/2)

- **PHY: providing a bit pipe**
- **Data rate:** the number of bits transmitted per seconds (**bit/s, or bps**)
- **Signal bandwidth and the Nyquist Sampling rule:**
 - To reconstruct a signal of bandwidth **H** Hz, we need **2H** samples/s
- **Channel capacity** for a channel of **BW** bandwidth:
 - **Shannon Capacity:** $C = BW \log_2(1 + \frac{S}{N})$ **bps** **Hz** **bit**
- **Modulation schemes:** digital (bit stream) -> analog (sinusoidal wave)
 - Amplitude Shifted Keying (**ASK**), AM
 - Frequency Shifted Keying (**FSK**), FM
 - Phase Shifted Keying (**PSK**), PM – perform well against noise
 - Quadratic Amplitude Modulation (QAM): AM + PM
 - Constellation diagram

$$s(t) = A \cos(2\pi f t + \theta)$$

Summary of PHY (2/2)

- **Spectrum for wireless communication is crowded**
 - Frequency and Wavelength $\lambda \cdot f = c$
 - Differentiate: **Channel BW** v.s. **Carrier Frequency f** (bands)
- **Multiplexing**: mixing flows of different users onto the same medium
 - **SDM, TDM, FDM, WDM** • • • 
 - **CDMA**
 - Direct Sequence Spread Spectrum (DSSS)
 - Large capacity, resistant against noise
 - **Chip sequence (Rule 1,2,3): encoding and decoding**